eclatchocolate.com — Site Review

Prepared for the Éclat Marketing & Branding Workshop · September 2026

Scope and method. I crawled the home page, About/Our Story, Product Collaborations, Tasting Guide, the Artisan Chocolate Bars collection, and a representative product page (Fallingwater Dark 65%), plus the global navigation and footer that appear on every page. Ratings are 1–10. Desktop pages were also viewed as rendered screenshots (home, product, collection, About) at 1515px; mobile was not captured and is worth checking live in the workshop.

Headline. This is a competent, well-photographed Shopify store for one of the best chocolatiers in the country. It sells the products; it undersells the maker. The site is organized like a catalog when the brand's real advantage is an atelier. Most of what follows is about closing that gap — and a good share of it is fixable in a week.

Composite: 5.6 / 10 (Visual 5.8 · Layout 5.2 · Organization 5.0 · Content 5.4)

1. Visual Appeal — 5.8

Item	Score	Notes
Product photography	**8**	Consistent silhouettes on white, sharp, well-lit. The cubes and caramels in particular look like design objects. This is the site's strongest asset.
Hero / lifestyle imagery	**7**	The current home hero is a strong photograph — open black box, rows of mondiants, the S'more Collection poster, Éclat mark in the corner. It looks expensive. The cocoa-bag About banner and the collaboration hero are also good. What's missing is people: no hands, no tempering, no shop interior, no Chris. A luxury food brand without a picture of its maker is leaving its best proof on the table.
Brand identity / theme	**5**	Rendered, it reads as Shopify's Dawn theme with a serif heading swapped in: light-weight grey serif headings, small body type, product cards in thin-bordered boxes, content held to roughly the middle 70% of a wide screen with empty margins either side. Nothing is *wrong*; nothing is *unmistakably Éclat* at 20 feet. No owned color, no signature typographic move, "Powered by Shopify" in the footer. Compare Patrick Roger's green or Marcolini's black jewel-box.
Home page first impression	**5**	The hero is S'mores — "A Reimagined Childhood Favorite." It's a good seasonal product, but as the first thing a new visitor sees it says *campfire nostalgia*, not *European-trained Master Chocolatier*. The hero should carry the positioning; seasonal promos belong one scroll down.

Item	Score	Notes
Micro-details that undercut luxury	**4**	Three things visible on every page or the key page: (1) a persistent "Enjoy 10% off your first order!" pill in the corner — discount messaging is the opposite of price integrity and it sits on top of a $125 Voyager box; (2) the bright purple "Buy with Shop" button under Add to Cart on product pages, the only saturated color on the site and it belongs to Shopify, not Éclat; (3) scroll-reveal animations that leave sections blank for a beat as you scroll, which reads as slow rather than elegant. All three are settings, not redesigns.
Logo walls	**6**	12 press logos + ~32 collaborator logos is impressive social proof, and it's presented as a wall. Curate to the 8–10 that matter for a luxury buyer (NYT, Vogue, Bon Appétit, Bourdain/Parts Unknown, Ripert, Tiffany, Four Seasons, Porsche, MoMA). One housekeeping item: the Virgin logo file appears to be a fan-made "concept" logo, not the official mark — swap or drop.

Suggestions

- Commission one half-day shoot: Chris in the atelier, hands, tempering, the shop on High Street. That single asset set fixes three rows above.
- Pick one owned color and one recurring graphic device (a foil seal, a rule, a monogram) and apply them to hero blocks, buttons, and packaging shots.
- Move the seasonal promo below a permanent brand hero.

2. Page Layout — 5.0

Item	Score	Notes
Home page structure	**6**	Sequence: seasonal hero → 3 product cards → collections carousel → 6 promo tiles → "Why Éclat" → press logos → email capture. It's coherent, but it's long and product-dense, and the maker story ("Why Éclat") sits below ten product tiles. Some section titles render twice ("Best Sellers" / "Artisan Chocolate Bars" appear duplicated in the collection cards) — likely a theme setting worth checking.
Product page	**5**	Two-column layout is clean: gallery left, title/price/cart/description right, a "You may also like" row below (the Fallingwater milk bar is there, which is right). The main photo shows two bare bars with no packaging — for a $17.50 bar the box is part of what's being sold; lead with it. The description is three paragraphs and no spec: missing cacao origin, net weight, ingredients, allergens, tasting notes, pairing, shelf life, and a warm-weather shipping note.
Collection page	**5**	Layout is standard and fine: title and intro left, hero image right, filter sidebar, three-up grid. Two issues. (a) The filter panel is mostly empty — "Chocolate Type" tags only 4 of 19 bars, "Flavor" tags 4 — so filters look broken to anyone who opens them. (b) A raw JSON rich-text blob (`{"type":"root","children":…`) sits in the page source at the bottom of the bars collection. It isn't visible on screen, so it's not urgent, but it's an unparsed metafield that search engines and screen readers see; worth cleaning.

Item	Score	Notes
About page layout	**4**	The story text sits in a single left column with the right half of the page empty for the entire scroll. It reads as unfinished. Either pull the text to a centered measure or — better — put the missing photographs of Chris and the atelier in that empty column.
Footer	**5**	Functional, but store hours still read "Monday (Labor Day): Closed" in mid-September. Stale hours in the footer of every page is the kind of detail luxury buyers notice.
Mobile	**n/a**	Not assessed in this pass. Given the mega-menu depth, worth checking the tap path from home to a single bar on a phone.

Suggestions

- Build a standard product-page spec block (origin · % · weight · ingredients · allergens · tasting notes · pairing) and populate it for every SKU. This is the single highest-leverage layout change on the site.
- Either fully tag the catalog for filters or hide the filter panel until it is; clean the JSON metafield out of the collection template.
- Replace the hard-coded holiday line with regular hours plus a separate "holiday hours" notice that gets removed after the holiday.

3. Site Organization — 5.0

Item	Score	Notes
Top-level navigation	**5**	Six top-level items: Shop, Gift Ideas, Corporate Gifts, Experience, About Éclat, Customer Care. "Corporate Gifts" appears at the top level *and* under Gift Ideas *and* under Customer Care — three entries for one page. "Recipes" appears under both Experience and About. "Occasions" appears three times, once misspelled "Occassions."
Shop mega-menu	**4**	Three facets (by Product ×10, by Flavor ×4, Signature Bars ×6) plus Browse All plus **Éclat T-Shirts**. That's 22 links before a visitor picks anything. "Mendiants" and "Mondiants™" sit next to each other and will confuse a newcomer — the trademark is a real asset, but it needs a one-line explainer wherever it appears. T-shirts do not belong in the primary shop menu of a luxury chocolatier.
Findability of the flagship	**4**	The Good & Evil bar — the product that made Éclat nationally known — is not in the bars collection and not in the navigation. If it's discontinued, the story still deserves a permanent home; if it's seasonal or allocated, that scarcity should be visible ("Next release: …"). Same for the Peruvian Nacional truffles.
Internal consistency	**5**	The home "Special Occasions" tile links to `/occasions/` while the nav links to `/pages/occasions` — verify the first isn't a 404. The country selector offers Canada, Chile, India, Israel, Netherlands, UK — all priced in USD. If international shipping isn't a real offering, remove the selector.

Item	Score	Notes
Experience section	**6**	Private Tastings + Tasting Guide + Recipes is the right *idea* for an atelier brand, and it's a differentiator few competitors have. It's under-weighted in the hierarchy relative to Corporate Gifts.

Suggested IA (for discussion)

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Shop        Chocolates (Assortments · Bars · Cubes · Caramels · Mendiants & Mondiants™ · Dragées
· Pantry)
            Gifts (by price · Corporate · Occasions · Gift cards)
Atelier     Christopher Curtin · How we make it · Origins · Collaborations · Accolades
Experience  Tastings · Tasting guide · Recipes
Visit       Shop & hours · Contact · Wholesale · FAQ · Shipping
```

Five top-level items, no duplicates, the maker gets a section, the flavor-profile facet becomes a filter instead of a menu.

4. Content — 5.4

Item	Score	Notes
Our Story / About	**5**	The raw material is exceptional — Compagnons du Devoir, first American Konditormeister in Cologne, Belgium/Switzerland/France/Germany/Japan. But the copy buries it under superlatives: "hallowed workshops," "closely guarded techniques and artisanal secrets," "unparalleled expertise," "distinguishes our chocolates from all others." Luxury copy states facts and lets the reader supply the awe. There's also no photo of Chris, no timeline, no team, and none of the specifics the press already tells (Van Dender and Marcolini in Brussels; Peru with Bourdain; three facilities; the R&D lab roasting Peru, Madagascar, and Dominican beans).
Product descriptions	**4**	The Fallingwater bar gets three paragraphs and not one sensory fact. "Bold, complex flavors that reflect the structural depth" of the building is a metaphor standing in for a tasting note. "Appeals to design lovers, chocolate connoisseurs, and anyone who appreciates sophisticated artistry" is filler. Collection intros ("comprehensive Chocolate Bar Collection," "approachable formats," "satisfy diverse preferences") read as SEO text and should be cut.
Tasting Guide	**7**	This is the best writing on the site and the voice the rest of it should adopt: "lavender flowers infused for 24 hours to extract only the lighter perfume oils," "Boxer Shiraz from Mollydooker," "single malt from Islay… subtle peaty flavor." Specific, confident, no adjectives doing the work of facts. Two gaps: it's a *list*, not a *guide* (no how-to-taste sequence, no order, no pairing), and the "Bolivian Truffle" image file is still named `peruvian-truffle` — check the photo matches the product.

Item	Score	Notes
Collaborations	**6**	The Good & Evil paragraph is strong storytelling — Pure Nacional, thought extinct for a century, hand-picked pods. But it's the only story on the page; 32 logos follow with no context. Three or four short case studies (Fallingwater, La Colombe's Morning Break bar, Porsche/McLaren, Tiffany) would convert this from a logo wall into proof of craft. "The most viral discussion of chocolate in history" is a claim worth softening or sourcing.
Voice consistency	**5**	Three voices coexist: the chocolatier's voice (Tasting Guide, Good & Evil), an SEO voice (collections, product pages, "Order now!" in the home meta description), and a promotional voice ("Chocolate concierges are standing by"). Pick the first one.
SEO / metadata	**5**	Home meta description ends "Elevate every chocolate experience. Order now!" — off-brand. Most secondary pages fall back to the same default og:description. Product titles are good ("Fallingwater Dark Chocolate Bar 65%"); one is malformed ("BRU Cacao Nibs - Éclat Chocolate"). Easy wins.
Provenance & sourcing	**4**	"Sustainably-sourced cacao" appears repeatedly and is never specified. Given the Nacional story and the R&D lab, Éclat has more real provenance than most competitors and shows less of it. One Origins page listing the beans, the countries, and why each is used would outperform every "sustainable" adjective on the site.

Suggestions

- Rewrite About as a dated timeline with photos: Madison → Paris → Cologne → Brussels/Tokyo → West Chester 2005 → Peru 2012 → today. Facts, not adjectives.
- Rewrite every product description in the Tasting Guide voice. Template: origin/percentage · what you taste · how it's made (one specific detail) · pairing. Four sentences beats three paragraphs.
- Turn the Tasting Guide into an actual guide: how to taste, suggested sequence (light to dark, plain to infused), what to drink with it.
- Add an Origins page and cut "sustainably sourced" everywhere it isn't backed by a named source.

5. Prioritized punch list

This week (housekeeping — no design decisions required)

1. Turn off the "10% off your first order" popup; hide or restyle the purple "Buy with Shop" button; switch off scroll-reveal animations.
2. Fix "Occassions" typo; remove duplicate nav entries (Corporate Gifts ×3, Recipes ×2, Occasions ×3).
3. Replace the Labor Day hours line.
4. Check `/occasions/` link; replace or remove the Virgin concept logo; verify the Bolivian truffle photo.
5. Rewrite the home meta description and the default og:description.
6. Move T-shirts out of the primary Shop menu; clean the JSON metafield out of the bars collection source.

This month (content)

7. Product-page spec block on every SKU.
8. Rewrite product and collection copy in the Tasting Guide voice; delete SEO filler.
9. About page as a timeline with a photo of Chris and the atelier.
10. Give Good & Evil and the Nacional truffles a permanent home, with availability status.

This quarter (positioning)

11. Permanent brand hero above the seasonal promo; maker story moves above product tiles.
12. Owned color / graphic device applied site-wide.
13. Origins page; three collaboration case studies.
14. Consolidate to the five-item IA.

6. What's already right (say this out loud in the room)

- The product photography is at the level of the competitors Éclat should be compared to.
- The Tasting Guide proves the brand already *has* the right voice — the job is to let it out of one page.
- The Experience section (private tastings, guide, recipes) is a structural advantage most chocolatiers don't have.
- The collaboration list is extraordinary. It just needs to be told, not listed.
- The story — first American Konditormeister, Compagnons du Devoir, the Bourdain/Ripert Nacional bar — is better than the site currently lets on. That's the best problem a website can have.